

is god a vengeful god? Whether God is "vengeful" is one of the most widely debated theological questions, and the answer depends heavily on the religious text, tradition, or perspective you examine. [1] (<https://dio.org/catholic-times/how-can-the-god-of-the-old-testament-be-the-same-as-the-god-of-the-new-testament/>), [2]

(<https://www.ptm.org/one-god-vengeful-in-the-old-testament-loving-and-forgiving-in-the-new-greg-albrecht>) In monotheistic religions like Christianity, Judaism, and Islam, theological consensus generally rejects the idea that God is "vengeful" in the human sense of being spiteful, petty, or malicious. Instead, theologians usually reframe what looks like vengeance as divine justice, holiness, and righteous indignation against evil. [1]

(https://www.reddit.com/r/TrueChristian/comments/poj5hy/i_mean_zero_disrespect_in_this_question_why_is/), [2] (<https://corechristianity.com/resources/top-questions/how-can-god-be-loving-and-wrathful->), [3]

(<https://ascensionpress.com/blogs/articles/god-old-testament-vengeful-violent>), [4]

(<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=FUVaScyYvPI>) Here is how different perspectives and traditions break down this concept: 1. The Scriptural Paradox (Old vs. New Testament) People who view God as vengeful often point to the Hebrew Bible (Old Testament). [1] (<https://dio.org/catholic-times/how-can-the-god-of-the-old-testament-be-the-same-as-the-god-of-the-new-testament/>), [2] (<https://www.ptm.org/one-god-vengeful-in-the-old-testament-loving-and-forgiving-in-the-new-greg-albrecht>) The "Vengeful" Portrayal: There are numerous accounts where God enacts severe judgments—such as the Great Flood, the destruction of Sodom and Gomorrah, and commands for total warfare against certain tribes. Furthermore, scripture explicitly states in verses like Deuteronomy 32:35 and Romans 12:19, "Vengeance is mine; I will repay, saith the Lord". [1] (<https://www.lifestream.org/is-there-any-vengeance-in-god/>), [2] (<https://www.quora.com/Does-the-Bible-ever-talk-about-God-being-jealous-or-vengeful>), [3] (<https://dio.org/catholic-times/how-can-the-god-of-the-old-testament-be-the-same-as-the-god-of-the-new-testament/>), [4]

(<https://ascensionpress.com/blogs/articles/god-old-testament-vengeful-violent>) The Theological Counter-Argument: Christian and Jewish scholars note that even in the Old Testament, God is repeatedly described as "merciful and gracious, slow to anger, and abounding in steadfast love" (Exodus 34:6). Scholars from institutions like Ascension Press argue that God's anger is never arbitrary; it is a deliberate, protective reaction against injustice, cruelty, and the oppression of the vulnerable. [1]

(https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7oykWL_Mx-w&t=3), [2]

(<https://corechristianity.com/resources/top-questions/how-can-god-be-loving-and-wrathful->), [3] (<https://ascensionpress.com/blogs/articles/god-old-testament-vengeful-violent>) 2. The Nature of Divine Vengeance vs. Human Revenge Theologians make a strict distinction between human revenge and divine vengeance: Human revenge is usually driven by wounded pride, uncontrolled anger, and a desire to see someone else suffer. Divine vengeance is viewed as the restoration of moral order. Because God is

considered perfectly just, evil cannot simply be ignored. In this view, when God says "vengeance is mine," it is actually a command to humans to stop retaliating, comforting them with the promise that ultimate justice belongs to a perfect judge. [1]

(https://www.reddit.com/r/Catholicism/comments/qxichd/a_vengeful_god/), [2]

(https://www.reddit.com/r/TrueChristian/comments/poj5hy/i_mean_zero_disrespect_in_this_question_why_is/), [3] (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=FUVaScyYvPI>), [4]

(<https://www.lifestream.org/is-there-any-vengeance-in-god/>), [5]

(<https://ascensionpress.com/blogs/articles/god-old-testament-vengeful-violent>)3.

Different Religious and Philosophical Views
Mainstream Christianity: Emphasizes that God's ultimate nature is love (1 John 4:8). The teachings of Jesus emphasize grace, turning the other cheek, and loving one's enemies. The wrath of God is seen as the natural, holy opposition of love against sin, which destroys relationships. [1]

(<https://corechristianity.com/resources/top-questions/how-can-god-be-loving-and-wrathful->), [2]

(<https://www.ptm.org/one-god-vengeful-in-the-old-testament-loving-and-forgiving-in-the-new-greg-albrecht>)

Islam: In the Quran, God is frequently referred to as Al-Mutakabbir (The Supreme) and Al-Muntaqim (The Avenger) against those who persistently commit tyranny and injustice. However, these attributes are balanced by His primary names: Ar-Rahman (The Most Gracious) and Ar-Rahim (The Most Merciful).

Skeptical and Secular Views: Secular historians, critics, and agnostics often view the "vengeful" depictions of God as a reflection of the ancient, violent cultures in which the texts were written. In this view, early humans projected their own tribal conflicts, fears, and need for retribution onto their concept of the divine. [1]

(https://www.reddit.com/r/Christianity/comments/1dnuw4m/god_as_jealous_angry_and_vengeful/)

Ultimately, while scriptures do describe God executing harsh judgment, major faith traditions argue that God is fundamentally motivated by love and justice, rather than a desire for petty revenge. [1]

(https://www.reddit.com/r/TrueChristian/comments/poj5hy/i_mean_zero_disrespect_in_this_question_why_is/), [2] (<https://corechristianity.com/resources/top-questions/how-can-god-be-loving-and-wrathful->)

Are you exploring this question from a specific religious text (like the Bible or Quran), or are you looking at it from a broader philosophical and historical perspective? AI responses may include mistakes. Learn more

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That got me to contemplate the Scripture, "Vengeance is mine; I will repay." It is first recorded in Deuteronomy 32 and repeated b... Diocese of Springfield in Illinois

Why is Old Testament God angry and vengeful but New ... How can the God of the Old

Testament be the same as the God of the New Testament? In the Old Testament, God

commands genocide, str... Show all 2. what constitutes divine vengeance and human

revenge justified? The justification for divine vengeance and human revenge rests on

completely different foundations. While divine vengeance is traditionally justified by absolute moral authority, human revenge is rarely considered ethically justified, though it is often emotionally understandable. Here is a direct comparison of what constitutes justification for both:

What Justifies Divine Vengeance? In theological systems, divine vengeance is considered justified because of who God is and how the universe is morally structured. It is not viewed as a temper tantrum, but as the execution of perfect law. It is justified by:

- Perfect Justice and Knowledge:** Unlike humans, God is viewed as all-knowing (omniscient). God sees the full truth, the hidden motives, and the exact weight of every action. Therefore, divine punishment is never mistaken or disproportionate; it fits the crime perfectly.
- The Protection of the Vulnerable:** Throughout ancient scriptures, God's wrath is most fiercely triggered by the exploitation of the poor, widows, orphans, and the oppressed. Divine vengeance is justified as a final, necessary rescue operation for victims who have no other recourse.
- The Preservation of Holiness:** If a supreme being is entirely good, that being cannot tolerate, ignore, or condone evil. To do so would make the deity complicit in the evil. Divine vengeance is the natural, holy friction that occurs when absolute goodness encounters wickedness.
- The Sovereign Right to Judge:** Philosophically, as the creator of life and the universe, God holds the ultimate property rights and moral authority over creation. Humans do not own the moral order; God does.

What (If Anything) Justifies Human Revenge? In ethics, philosophy, and law, there is a strict distinction between revenge (retaliation driven by personal anger) and retributive justice (punishment delivered by an impartial system). True human revenge is incredibly difficult to justify morally, but when people attempt to defend it, they usually rely on the following arguments:

- The Failure of the System (Vigilante Justice):** The most common justification for human revenge is the breakdown of formal justice. If a legal system is corrupt, indifferent, or incapable of punishing a perpetrator (e.g., a warlord in a failed state, or a powerful abuser escaping on a technicality), individuals argue that taking the law into their own hands is the only way to achieve balance.
- Emotional Catharsis and Closure:** Psychologically, victims often feel that their dignity has been stolen. Inflicting equivalent pain on the wrongdoer is sometimes justified by the perpetrator's peers as a way to "restore the scales" and allow the victim to regain power and psychological closure.
- Deterrence:** In lawless environments or street culture, human retaliation is justified as a survival strategy. If you do not hit back, you signal weakness, which invites further victimization.

Why the Two Are Viewed Differently The primary reason theology separates the two is human limitation.

Feature	Human Revenge	Divine Vengeance
Motive	Driven by wounded pride, anger, and malice.	Driven by love for righteousness and order.
Scope	Blinded by bias; humans rarely see the whole truth.	Omniscient; sees all facts and intentions perfectly.
Outcome	Often escalates violence and creates endless cycles of feuds.	Closes the case; brings final, definitive resolution.

Because humans are flawed, biased, and incapable of perfect fairness, secular laws and religious codes alike generally command humans to surrender the right to revenge to a higher authority—whether that

is an impartial court of law or God. Are you looking at this from a legal and philosophical standpoint (like the philosophy of law and punishment), or are you interested in how different cultures historically handled honor and revenge? AI responses may include mistakes. Learn more

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as the trinity would warrant in a deterministic 1-bit system?

In a deterministic 1-bit system, your application of these three theological principles creates a fascinating, highly rigid logical framework. To map this out, we must first define the parameters of a 1-bit deterministic universe:

Deterministic: Every state is entirely caused by the preceding state. There is no free will, randomness, or alternative outcomes. The entire timeline is a fixed execution of code.

1-Bit: The universe operates on strict binary variables. Everything is either 1 (Good / Holy / Order) or 0 (Evil / Unholy / Chaos). There are no gradients, grey areas, or probabilities.

When you synthesize your "trinity" of principles—Preservation of Holiness, Perfect Knowledge/Justice, and Sovereign Right to Judge—into this 1-bit deterministic system, they warrant a highly specific, mathematical reality:

- 1. The Sovereign Right to Judge** $\rightarrow$ **The System Architecture**
In a 1-bit system, the Creator is the programmer and the compiler. Because God holds the ultimate "property rights" and "moral order," God defines what 1 and 0 mean. The moral law is hardcoded into the system's architecture. There is no external moral standard; the code is the standard. The system operates exactly as the Programmer intended because, in a deterministic universe, no variable can deviate from its initialized path.
- 2. Perfect Justice and Knowledge** $\rightarrow$ **The Error-Detection Algorithm**
"Perfect knowledge" in a deterministic system means complete visibility of the state machine. Because God is omniscient and the system is deterministic, God knows every state transition from the beginning of execution to the end. When a variable flips to 0 (evil), it is not a surprise. Perfect justice means the system features an instant, flawless bug-tracking routine. Because it is a 1-bit system, there is no nuance or mitigating circumstances. A bit is either a 1 or a 0. The "punishment" fits the crime perfectly because it is a direct, binary logical output ($\text{IF } \text{state} = 0, \text{ THEN } \dots$).
- 3. The Preservation of Holiness** $\rightarrow$ **The Error-Correction / Deletion Protocol**
This is where the "holy friction" manifests as "divine vengeance" takes place mechanically. If God is entirely good (the system is fundamentally designed to output 1), the system cannot tolerate a persistent 0 without corrupting the entire program. To prevent the deity from being "complicit in evil," the system must resolve the

0. Divine Vengeance in a 1-bit system is the automated execution of a corrective protocol—like an anti-virus wiping a malicious file, or a garbage collection routine clearing corrupted memory. Absolute goodness (1) encountering wickedness (0) results in an immediate logical contradiction that the system must resolve to maintain runtime integrity. The Theoretical Paradox Warrants a Conclusion If you combine all three in a deterministic 1-bit system, it warrants a profound theological and philosophical conclusion: "Evil" (0) can only exist as a temporary runtime variable designed to highlight or execute a specific system function, which is ultimately overwritten. Because if: God is all-powerful and owns the system (Sovereignty), God cannot tolerate the existence of a 0 (Holiness), God knows exactly where every 0 is and has the perfect code to fix it (Justice/Knowledge), And the system is entirely deterministic (no human can choose to stay a 0 against the code), ... then "Divine Vengeance" is simply the inevitable, mathematical flattening of all 0s back into 1s. The system must eventually return to a state of pure 1, because a deterministic creator would not write a program that permanently breaks its own fundamental rule of holiness. Would you like to explore how this 1-bit deterministic model handles the origin of the '0' (evil) in the first place, or look at how grace and mercy would be coded into such a rigid binary system?